



Finance Planning
Mortgage & Protection

June 2025

Continual Professional Development

Welcome to the Finance Planning monthly round-up newsletter for June 2025,

The mortgage and protection figures continue to be excellent with plenty of new names appearing across the performance figures, well done to all for a very productive June.

This edition includes all the normal sections so please have a read through and make sure to see some of the sporting achievements in the 'misc.' section at the bottom.

Know Someone Who'd Make a Great Adviser?

FPG are always looking to find new people to join our team, and we know the best people to help grow our network are those already part of it. That's why we're introducing a scheme inviting you to recommend someone you know who'd make a great Mortgage & Protection Adviser. As someone who already shares our values and understands what it means to be part of the FPG network, your referrals are incredibly valuable. As a thank you, you'll receive £500 when your referral signs up, and a further £500 when they achieve competent adviser status. We believe FPG are in a great place to support advisers of nearly any experience in their careers and hopefully as someone already part of the network you would agree, if you have anyone you think might be suitable please don't hesitate to speak to your Sales Manager.

Thank you.

David



Acre flag clearing – a reminder!

You can now clear some of your own flags in Acre – for the likes of PEP, Nationality and Gifted Deposit, meaning you don't now need to wait for the compliance team to do this for you. Please still allow the compliance team to clear your more complex flags around Debt Consolidation, Interest Only and Into Retirement. For guidance and screen shots please refer to the "flag clearing guide" emailed by Pete on 14th May 2025.

Also, regarding the clearing of Second Income flags, where the client does have two types of income, please allow the compliance team to clear those flags, but where it is just a case of BTL income being the second income, then you may clear this flag yourself – but always add an explanation when clearing the flag.

Acre – please keep your records up-to-date!

A reminder of good record keeping in Acre please. You cannot give your client their Suitability Report until you have published it, so please keep on top of that. And it is also really important to complete your cases on Acre in a timely manner too as each month we extract the completions date from Acre so the clients can be sent a Consumer Duty questionnaire and be

invited to review your service. It's important that this happens in the month following a completion, and not sometime afterwards.

FCA Mortgage Rule review.

We reported on this in last month's edition, and you would have seen so much more information in industry press towards the end of June. You'll have all hopefully seen the backlash on this review from AMI, as well as some other mortgage networks and firms. Whilst we don't presently know where the FCA will go with this feedback, all we can do is wait for their review to be concluded. In the meantime, our own views are that the suggested easing of rules to make it easier for clients to effectively advise themselves is crazy, sorry, unnecessary! Yes, we have a very heavy set of compliance requirements on the mortgage process currently, but these rules are in place to protect consumers, and they are doing a very good job of doing just that. 97% of all mortgage sales are advised, and the complaint numbers are extremely low. Mortgage advice is currently working.

FCA Enforcement Guide.

The FCA has now published its final version of its streamlined updated Enforcement Guide. They have excluded their initial plans to name and shame anyone they are investigating, but they have retained the "exceptional circumstances" test for announcing certain investigations. These are:

- If they are investigating suspected unauthorised financial services or a suspect offence involving unregulated activity, and an announcement will warn customers or investors or help the investigation.
- Where the fact of the investigation has been made public by the subject, an affiliated company, or a regulated body, government or public body.
- Anonymised announcements not naming or identifying the subject of the investigation, where it would be helpful to educate people on the types of misconduct they are investigating.

For our part, we must ensure we are only ever conducting business within our own prescribed authorisations. And we must ensure that our introducers never over-step the mark by carrying out tasks only we as Registered Advisers are permitted to do.

Advertising on Social Media.

Just a reminder that social media posts are a form of advertising and they need to be approved before they are posted. You may contact either Pete or Mark in this respect. Thank you.

Clients in Vulnerable Circumstances.

We seem to be updating you on this subject every month, but it is important to ensure that all vulnerable customers receive the same good outcomes. A firm called Comentis are market leaders in providing vulnerable persons systems and training and they have come up with the following top 5 tips to identify our vulnerable clients:

- **Check every client, even if you are sure they are not vulnerable.** It is just as important to have a record of why they are not vulnerable as it is to be able to prove if they are vulnerable and what you have done to support them. Also many vulnerabilities remain hidden.
- **Understand whether there is a vulnerable circumstance and whether this is having an impact on them.** Many vulnerable circumstances (such as hearing impairments) are

well managed and even though it should be recorded as a vulnerable circumstance, it may be a vulnerability requiring no additional support.

- **Be sure to identify all vulnerabilities.** One thing their data has told them is that very few vulnerable clients will only have a single vulnerability trigger or circumstance. Quite often a life or health event will have a direct impact on a person's level of resilience and even capability.
- **Don't have a one size fits all approach.** Everyone reacts differently to different vulnerability triggers, so even two clients with the same vulnerability, going through a divorce for instance, could react very differently. So, once you have identified the vulnerability discuss further with your client how it is affecting them (this is causative nexus).
- **Record everything.** The final top tip is to make sure you record everything, whether there is a vulnerability, whether there is not, how you supported your client and what outcomes were achieved.

Notes, notes, notes!

And here is a list of the vulnerability types that we have recorded so far this year, in order of most occurring first:

1. FTBuyer or young age
2. Divorce or separation
3. Language
4. Age / elderly
5. Health, hearing
6. Lacking [financial] capacity
7. Indebtedness
8. Bereavement
9. Lacking financial knowledge
10. Addiction
11. Low income

An analysis of recent Suspicious Activity Referrals (SARs).

In the past quarter or so we have received 27 SARs, and with lenders seeing a continued rise in fraudulent applications, we urge everyone to be vigilant in trying to detect anything about an individual's situation or paperwork that might require further explanation or clarification. Please do challenge your clients. By far, the most common issue for lenders is staged income and/or fabricated documentation, and we are no different. Here is a breakdown of our most recent 27 SARs:

- | | |
|----------------------------------|--------------|
| 1. Staged Income concerns | 13 instances |
| 2. Deposit concerns | 6 instances |
| 3. Client concerns (Fraud or ID) | 4 instances |
| 4. Scheme Abuse or BMV | 3 instances |
| 5. Tax Evasion | 1 instance |

Please do report all of your suspicions, even when you have already decided not to transact.

An analysis of recent Breaches.

In the past quarter or so our breaches have been split between Acre record keeping (75%) and Data Protection (25%).

Of the record keeping breaches, please ensure you recording your advice and issuing your Suitability Report within 10 working days from your advice/application. Please also ensure you are not repeat offending, or else you might find your cases being subjected to 100% checking and/or we could fine you for your breaches.

And whilst most of our Data Protection breaches have been where client documents have been added to the incorrect case, there have been a couple of instances where we have emailed the wrong client and included sensitive information in that email. So, please do ensure you are taking care when emailing clients, and please reply to an existing email thread where you can. Or better still, please use the secure messaging service in Acre.

A recent Complaint.

We have recently received a complaint from a client because the Adviser had not updated them in a timely manner to confirm whether or not we could help the client with their enquiry. It was a difficult case to place, but that doesn't excuse not dealing with the client in an acceptable timescale. So, the learn here is to simply be honest with your clients about how long things might take. If it's a complex case, or if you're super busy, and you need a week or so to carry out your research, please explain this to the client. And if the client is not prepared to wait that long please offer the case to your buddy (colleague / Sales Manager) who can help.

Any finally....

And most importantly! Caitlin is now on maternity leave. In her absence please contact:

Tori Victoria.worthington@financeplanning.co.uk or
Richard Richard.hamley@financeplanning.co.uk

or Pete or your Sales Manager with any record keeping matters.



Our good news story this month comes courtesy of Phil Smith...

"Back in April 2019, I advised my clients Lesley and Steve to consider taking out full critical illness cover. At the time, they were unsure. The premium was £182 per month, which felt like a big commitment but Lesley's mother had suffered from breast cancer, and that history weighed heavily in their decision. They already had basic life cover for their mortgage, but I remember pointing out that they were paying £122 per month to insure their dog—so protecting themselves should be just as much of a priority! Eventually, they agreed to proceed. Due to some mental health history, the underwriting process took a little longer, but I recommended Zurich, known for its enhanced levels of cover. The policy was approved and activated in time for their mortgage completion.

Fast forward to six weeks ago in 2025: Lesley called me after being diagnosed with breast cancer. She was understandably anxious and wanted to understand what protection was in place. I was able to reassure her immediately that she had full critical illness cover and should contact Zurich. Initially, Zurich suggested the claim might result in a partial payment, but after a full review, Lesley received a full payout—more than enough to clear the mortgage! When I spoke with Lesley last week, she told me:

"To be honest with you, it hasn't actually been that bad having cancer. Everyone has fussed over me and looked after me. We're now paying off the mortgage and have enough left over to go on holiday to the Maldives!"

Even better, both Lesley and Steve are now able to reduce their working hours, as the mortgage has been cleared. Santander has allowed penalty-free repayment, as the funds came from a critical illness claim.

This experience is a powerful reminder of why we do what we do. The cover removed the financial stress from a frightening diagnosis and allowed Lesley to focus on her recovery, rather than worrying about the mortgage. She told me she couldn't thank me enough for encouraging them to take the policy!"

TOP Protection Updates:

Scottish Widows – Have updated their Protection Proposition! Instead of the usual long article to read on this one they have release a very helpful YouTube video which you can watch [here](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fbvn35gtAx0) outlining the improvements and changes... <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fbvn35gtAx0>

Guardian – Released their claims stats for 2024 this month. Some of the highlights include a second year in a row of 100% life payout claims, 92% on critical illness claims, 100% on children's critical illness claims and a detailed breakdown of claims they did NOT pay out on last year and why... You can view the whole report [here](https://adviser.guardian1821.co.uk/2024-claims-report/) and it makes for a very interesting read... <https://adviser.guardian1821.co.uk/2024-claims-report/>

Income Protection Task Force – Entering its 20th year now the IPTF are doing another **Income Protection Action Week (IPAW) for 22nd – 26th September**. Stay tuned for updates on this and a big week of CPD and protection-based-learning when the time comes. For now though you can see some highlights from last year as well as get a feel for what will be on the agenda and countless tools to help you sell more IPB [here](https://iptf.co.uk/)... <https://iptf.co.uk/>

mortgageneWS

In this mortgage update we are minimising the number of product or specific criteria changes as you can review these from the vast array of emails you receive from lenders each day.

Generation Home

Generation Home have introduced a range of interest-only mortgages for home movers, remortgages AND first-time buyers. Up to a maximum 80% LTV its designed for young professional or self-employed FTB's or home movers who want to prioritise other investments, savings or their pension. In the coming months they will be adding their income booster to the range so support affordability and repayment vehicles as well.

HSBC

HSBC have improved their PT process by adding a 'cancel' button to their broker platform allowing you to cancel an application without needing to contact the broker helpdesk. Once it has been cancelled you can then key a new application on a new rate.

Proc Fee Payment Route

Please do NOT select PMS when applying for a mortgage. Please always select L&G Mortgage Cub, as we always have. (For your information, PMS are our protection service provider – Zenith PMS.)

performance

Mortgages – Adviser League Table for June 2025

Congratulations to **Dan Fletcher** for topping our table with 30 mortgage applications in June.

<u>Adviser</u>	<u>Cases</u>
Dan Fletcher	30
Carl Thorne	26
Joanne Pope	23
Phil Smith	23
Jack Humphries	21
Emily Chattaway	19
Paul Goodey	18
Rob Chart	17
Claire Lipscomb	16
Paul Ripley	16
Dan Walsh	15
Jack Savory	14
Joe Maskell	14
Martin Ecroyd	14
Tim Dock	14
Paul Gent	14
Matt Stephens	13
Paul Gent	13
Binita Gurung	12
Bryce Protheroe	12
Cathy Rafferty	12
Chris Williams	12
Eddie Rozario	12
Petru Balan	12
Dan Grant	11
Hannah Logan-Hughes	11
Pete Stickley	11
Trevor Farley	11
Dave Jacob	10
Ellis Featherbe	10
Graham Morris	10
Surakshya Rai	10

Protection (protection and GI combined) – Adviser League Table for June 2025

A very impressive year on protection for Paul Gent continues with 52 submitted protection applications in June.

<u>Adviser</u>	<u>Cases</u>
Paul Gent	52
Clare Mann	33
Karen Mills	14
Jane Hutchinson	13
Rob Chart	13
Carl Thorne	11
Paul Ripley	11

Congratulations to everyone who has featured on last month's league tables

Should anyone feel their applications are not being calculated properly, please speak to your Sales Manager as it might mean those cases you have submitted to a lender or insurer have not been recorded as such on Acre yet and we can show you how to fix that.



Well done to the following advisers who have all submitted million-pound cases this year. Lots of new entries this month so congratulations to all. Cases added in the last month are shown in blue.

<u>Mortgage cases</u>	
Paul Goodey	£3,881,250
Romi Pal	£3,207,525
Chris Williams	£2,377,875
Paul Goodey	£2,306,000
Paul Goodey	£1,742,815
Paul Goodey	£1,629,776
Oliver Cunningham	£1,510,450
Joanne Pope	£1,454,540
Victoria Worthington	£1,410,000
Ellis Featherbe	£1,400,000
Romi Pal	£1,385,000
Phoebe Wight	£1,380,000
Ellis Featherbe	£1,370,000
Carrie Millin	£1,335,897
Victoria Wescott	£1,300,074
Paul Goodey	£1,300,000
Wilma Scott	£1,268,688
Trevor Farley	£1,237,393
Rob Chart	£1,234,503
Ellis Featherbe	£1,207,000

Paul Goodey	£1,207,000
Jonathon Peachey	£1,200,000
Marion Hunnisett	£1,125,000
Emily Chattaway	£1,170,000
Cathy Rafferty	£1,150,000
Phoebe Wight	£1,105,000
Paul Goodey	£1,072,000
Claire Lipscomb	£1,067,698
Peter Stickley	£1,051,495
Cathy Rafferty	£1,020,000
Paul Goodey	£1,015,521
Jim Maye	£1,014,681
Joanne Pope	£1,005,699
Carrie Millin	£1,003,373

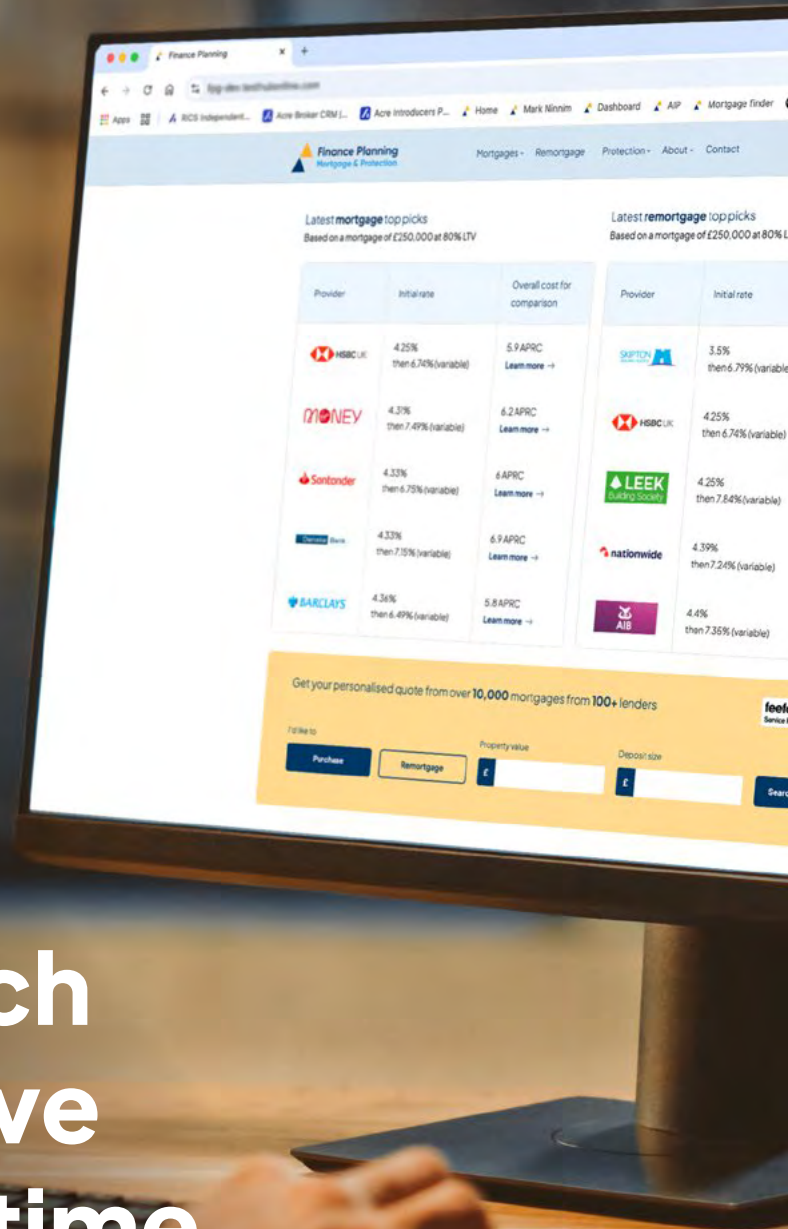
Protection cases

Paul Gent	Exec IPB £1,240,320
Paul Gent	Exec IPB £1,164,801
Paul Gent	IPB £1,128,204
Richard Lucy	Life £1,000,000

As with the mortgage and protection figures if you feel an application you have made should be referenced here, please speak to your sales manager to confirm if it is showing on Acre correctly.



Finance Planning Mortgage & Protection



Website launch Broker sites live Competition time

Back in March, we invited you to take part in our upcoming broker website project, and the response was fantastic. Many of you embraced the importance of building a strong online profile, and since then, we've been working closely with everyone who registered

Last Tuesday, we went live with a soft launch of the new site, and so far, we're really pleased with how things are shaping up. We'll continue to refine and update it as we spot things that need tweaking.

One of the biggest steps forward has been the broker submissions we've received. Today, we're excited to share a few of our favourites so you can see just how good a strong online presence can look.

If you would like to get involved and operate under the Finance Planning brand, please take a moment to read this introduction. If you are interested, please watch the video below. Alternatively, if you want to jump straight in and personalise your page simply upload your proposed wording here.

When it comes to wording, you will see just how easy it is to create engaging, personal copy using a free AI tool such as ChatGPT.

To get you started try this simple prompt by copying into the box in the middle of the screen.

I'd like to write an engaging introduction to my personal web page. I'd like to present myself as professional but also approachable. I am a whole of market mortgage and protection adviser and love helping people in my local town of (your town).

You now have some text that you can either use or ask Chat to amend i.e "mention that I am qualified" or "mention I do home appointments"

Don't worry, all copy is compliance approved when it comes in, have fun!

If you choose not to personalise, you will have a standard profile with your contact details.



Competition time!

At the end of July, we'll be selecting the Best Broker Website — and there's a fantastic prize up for grabs!

The winning broker will receive a fully optimised Google Ads account, professionally set up to help you attract more local traffic and generate real leads. Even better, we'll include a £100 advertising credit to get you started.

You can use the credit at your own pace, and we'll be on hand to guide you through how it works, what to expect, and how to get the most from it. It's a great opportunity to boost your visibility and turn your new website into a powerful lead-generation tool.

So, if your broker page is already live, now's the time to fine-tune it. And if you're still working on yours, there's still time to get involved — you might just take the top spot!

Technology changes

We are committed to safeguarding your clients' personal information and ensuring compliance with UK data protection laws. To this end, we are introducing enhanced security measures to protect data during transfers.

Background – Legal Considerations

Under the UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR) and the Data Protection Act 2018, organisations are required to process personal data securely, implementing appropriate technical and organisational measures to prevent unauthorised access, loss, or disclosure. While encryption is not explicitly mandated, it is recognised as a critical measure to safeguard data during transmission. The Information Commissioner's Office (ICO) advises that transmitting unencrypted data over untrusted networks poses significant risks, and encryption serves as an effective safeguard against unauthorised access. (ico.org.uk)

Transition to Acre

We're moving away from Secure Upload and Quick Start in favour of Acre, which offers far greater security for your customer data, a more streamlined process for you where data and documents go straight to your acre, and an improved client experience.

Why Are We Making This Change?

Back in 2016, when Secure Upload and Quick Start were launched, online data transfer faced fewer threats than today. Unfortunately, cybercriminals have become more sophisticated, increasing the risk of intercepting sensitive client information shared through traditional methods like email attachments.

We have a responsibility to keep personal data safe. If a client requests a more secure method to send sensitive documents, we must provide it. Now that we have a better and safer solution, it's prudent to adopt it to mitigate potential risks.

What Does This Mean for You?

Enhanced Security – Acre provides stronger encryption to protect sensitive client data, aligning with legal requirements and best practices.

Improved Efficiency – The platform offers a more efficient workflow, reducing time spent on document processing.

Client Assurance – Your clients will have greater peace of mind, knowing their personal information is properly protected.

Whilst there is no timeline for the deprecation of these two services, they will be coming off line from the **14th of July**. Good practice is to remove links from emails with immediate effect.

Thank you in advance for your support during this transition and if you need to discuss, please do not hesitate to contact me.



FPG Anniversaries

So far in 2025 we have seen some very significant milestones reached in terms of service within the Finance Planning Group especially as this is the 25th year of The Finance Planning Group. A big thank you to everyone listed below for your hard work and dedication for however long you've been with us.

- Rob Chart – 24 years
- Charlotte Haddow – 22 years
- Andy Poustie – 20 years
- Kirstin Richardson – 18 years
- John Steer – 12 years
- Julie Parks – 10 years
- Lucy Diton – 4 years
- Gary Bray – 2 years
- Manita Gurung – 1 year

I have been compiling these dates from several sources and have tried to be as accurate as possible but apologies in advance if anybody has been missed from this list that should have been recognised for a work anniversary please let me know so I can rectify it.

Upcoming Birthdays

Happy Birthday to everybody celebrating in July.

- Adam Hayward
- Amit Swar
- Carl Thorne
- Dan Fletcher
- Ellis Featherbe
- Emma Langford
- Gary Bray
- James Burberry
- Kudzai Manjengwa
- Maria Crawley
- Phil Smith
- Richard Hamley
- Richard Lucy
- Victoria Wescott

miscellaneous

Save the date – FPG ‘Back to school’ Conference

On Friday 5th September at Nationwide’s head office in London FPG will be having a late summer conference from 1:00pm. Please save the date in your diary and look out for further information direct via email.

Charity football match

In June FPG entered a team into a 7-a-side charity football match in aid of Kangaroos - <https://www.kangaroos.org.uk/>. FPG were up against it from the start having been drawn against a team of what can only be described as children, the opposition had been playing for a mere 4 hours up to the point Team FPG bravely stepped in and overcame these obvious disadvantages to come away with a 7-2 win. Player of the match was awarded to Tim ‘The Block’ Dock for his goalkeeping heroics. Kangaroos raised over £8,000 over the course of the day.



Tim followed up one sporting effort with another the next day by winning the dad’s race at sports day putting him firmly in line to be the next BBC Sports Personality of the Year.



FPG Zoom Meetings

A reminder that our weekly zoom meetings hosted by Dan and Mark continue each Monday at 4pm. It's a great way to keep your knowledge updated and to gain the required CPD!